

TOPIC 7: POST-CIVIL WAR NIGERIA – RECONSTRUCTION, RECONCILIATION, REHABILITATION

1. The Three Rs

After the war, the Federal Government under Gowon emphasised three related goals:

- **Reconstruction** – rebuilding infrastructure, roads, schools, hospitals and the economy damaged by the war.
- **Reconciliation** – healing ethnic and regional wounds; encouraging unity and acceptance of former Biafrans as full citizens again.
- **Rehabilitation** – helping displaced persons, war victims, and former Biafran soldiers and civilians to return to normal life, including jobs, education and housing.

2. Measures Taken

Amnesty for many who fought on the Biafran side, restoration of federal presence in the East, use of oil revenue for development projects, and appeals for national unity. Challenges remained: bitterness, economic hardship in war-affected areas, and the need for lasting political solutions.

3. Significance

The Three Rs aimed to prevent a cycle of revenge and to hold Nigeria together. How fully they were achieved is still debated, but they shaped the official approach to nation-building after 1970.

4. Summary

Post-war policy focused on reconstruction of infrastructure, reconciliation among communities, and rehabilitation of victims. The goal was a united Nigeria without collective punishment of the East.

End of Topic 7